Japan in World War II, both events occurring over seven decades previously. A visitor to China in these years saw little abatement of anti-Japanese portrayals on Chinese television; on any given night, at least a third if not more of prime-time dramas on stations from all of China's major provinces were about Japan's invasion of China, given verisimilitude thanks to actors speaking fluent Japanese.[5]

If the Chinese are focused on the past, the Japanese are most concerned about the present and future. In the same polls cited earlier, nearly 65 percent of Japanese claimed that the ongoing Senkaku Islands dispute accounted for their negative view of China, while over 50 percent cited the "seemingly hegemonic actions of the Chinese" for leaving an unfavorable impression. Overall, 80 percent of Japanese polled by Pew responded that they were either very or somewhat concerned that territorial disputes with China could lead to military conflict, versus 59 percent of Chinese.[6]

These negative impressions and fears of war come despite nearly unprecedented levels of economic interaction between the two countries. Even with China's recent economic slowdown, according to the CIA *World Factbook*, Japan was China's third-largest trade partner, accounting for 6 percent of its exports and nearly 9 percent of its imports; China was Japan's largest trade partner, taking 17.5 percent of its exports and providing a full quarter of its imports.[7] Though exact numbers are difficult to ascertain, it has been claimed that Japanese firms directly or indirectly employ as many as ten million Chinese, most of them on the mainland.[8] The neoliberal assumption that greater economic ties raise the threshold for security conflicts is being tested in the Sino-Japanese case, with both proponents and critics of the concept able to claim that so far, their interpretation is correct. Since the downturn in relations during the administration of Junichiro Koizumi (2001–6), Japanese academics such as Masaya Inoue have described the relationship as *seirei keinetsu*: politically cool, economically hot. That relationship is reflected in another way by the surging number of Chinese tourists to Japan, who totaled nearly 6.4 million in 2016,[9] whereas the China National Tourism Administration claims that nearly